PRIVATE · PREPARED FOR MANAVV · DO NOT SHARE

The Commercial Half

Your role in the first call with
Thomas Joshi, Associate, NEA
Monday 19 October 2026 · Pacific Time

MEETING	Thomas Joshi — Associate, Technology Investing, NEA
YOUR ROLE ON THE CALL	CBO — market, pricing, competition, GTM
YOUR JOB IN ONE LINE	Make the market legible and the plan credible. Do not pitch.
ASK ON THE TABLE	$1.5M on a $12M post-money SAFE
PREPARED FOR	Manavv — CBO, Evo

This is not a shorter version of Bhavit's book. It is the other half. He carries the product and the engineering; you carry the market, the pricing, the competition and the go-to-market. On a first call with an associate, those are the questions that decide whether the memo says 'big enough' or 'niche tool'.

Contents

00	Your job on this call	**3**
01	Who you are talking to, from a commercial angle	**4**
02	The market, built bottom-up — and how to defend it	**5**
03	Positioning: the sentence that wins the category	**7**
04	The competitive map — and the five names he will say	**8**
05	Pricing: $108, and the arithmetic behind it	**9**
06	Go-to-market: the first 5,000 users	**11**
07	The business model he will test to destruction	**12**
08	The fifteen commercial questions	**13**
09	The numbers you own	**16**
10	Working the call with Bhavit	**17**
11	When to stay quiet	**18**
12	Your follow-up: the market appendix	**19**
13	Cheat sheet	**20**
14	The comparables, and exactly what each one proves	**21**
15	How category winners described themselves early	**23**
16	What kills prosumer companies — and which of these you have	**24**
17	Pre-seed benchmarks: what "good" looks like	**25**
18	The launch playbook, in detail	**26**
19	The ninety days after a yes	**28**
20	Rehearsal drills	**29**
21	Your own narrative	**30**
22	Final checklist	**31**
23	Three objections, scripted in full	**32**
24	Evidence appendix: what each figure is worth	**34**

00 Your job on this call

Associates at funds the size of NEA are not usually the person who kills a pre-seed on the market. They kill it on fit : is this a venture-scale opportunity, or a very good product with a ceiling? That question is yours. Bhavit will win the argument that the thing works. You have to win the argument that it can become large.

00.1 The three things you must land

What you must land	The evidence	Where in this book
The market is bigger than a Mac utility, and the expansion path is specific.	6.1M US computer/mathematical professionals as the beachhead; 70.7M management and professional; ~1B knowledge workers as the ceiling. Then cross-device, then the agent context layer.	Section 02
The pricing is deliberate, not guessed.	$108/year against Granola ($18/mo), Raycast Pro ($8/mo), ChatGPT Pro ($20/mo), Workona (~$7–8/mo). Free core is the acquisition engine; Pro is the retention product.	Section 05
The go-to-market is a demo, not an ad budget.	The 'Hey Evo, continue' clip is the entire top of funnel; Show HN, Product Hunt, Mac power-user newsletters, creator videos, and a 300-person warm list.	Section 06

00.2 The one thing you must not do

WARNING

Do not answer a product or engineering question. If he asks how classification works, how restoration is implemented, or why Rust — hand it to Bhavit in one sentence: "That's Bhavit's area — the short version is the engine is 16 crates with a regression gate; he can go deeper." A CBO who improvises on architecture reads as a founder who does not know his own company. A CBO who defers cleanly reads as a team that knows its own split.

00.3 How the call will actually flow for you

Minutes	What is happening	Your state
0–5	Bhavit opens, frames, states the problem.	Muted. On camera. Listening. Do not nod continuously — it reads as nervous on video.
5–11	Demo.	Watch the chat panel. If he types a question during the demo, answer it in text so Bhavit does not break the flow.
11–20	Bhavit takes product and technical questions.	Take notes on every question he asks. You will need them for the follow-up.
20–27	You get the commercial questions: market, pricing, competition, GTM.	Answer in the order given in section 08. Short answers, one number each.
27–30	Bhavit closes, asks for next step.	One sentence of support at most. Do not add a second close.

01 Who you are talking to, from a commercial angle

You do not need his biography — Bhavit's book has it. You need to know what he believes about markets, because your answers should be shaped by it.

01.1 Four beliefs that shape how he hears your market answer

His belief	Where it comes from	What it means for you
Generalist AI is commoditising; specialised companies win on a proprietary corpus, a closed loop, and a verifier.	"The Neolab Wild West", NEA blog, June 2026 (co-authored with Lila Tretikov).	Do not sell a horizontal 'AI memory for everyone'. Sell a wedge with a corpus that compounds and an outcome that is verifiable.
The exit for AI-native companies is a strategic that is buying capability it cannot build, not a general acquisition.	Same essay: strategics "are buying specific capability, not general intelligence"; top-decile software trades at 15–18× NTM revenue.	Your exit story should name capability buyers, not just 'a big company'. Think Atlassian, Adobe, Microsoft, Notion, Raycast's acquirer profile.
AI products need outcome-grounded metrics inside production workflows, not lab benchmarks.	His NEA profile.	Never quote a TAM without a conversion assumption attached. He will ask what the funnel actually is.
Craft matters — he says he can tell when a product was made with love.	His NEA profile.	Talk about the product the way a user would, not the way a consultant would. Specific beats strategic.

01.2 What he is comparing you to

Every associate has a mental set of comps. For Evo, the likely set is:

Company	Why it is in his head	The lesson to draw
Granola	Mac-first meeting notetaker; $4.25M seed (2023) → $125M Series C at $1.5B (March 2026). The closest prosumer-Mac success of the last three years.	Started with a narrow job (meeting notes), expanded into context infrastructure, and never abandoned the prosumer wedge for enterprise. That is exactly Evo's sequence.
Raycast	Mac power-user launcher; $47.9M raised; Pro at $8/mo; expanding to Windows and iOS.	A Mac-only prosumer tool can become a platform. But it took three years of free usage before monetising — a reminder that the free core is a strategy, not a giveaway.
Rewind / Limitless	NEA portfolio company; $33M+ raised; Mac app killed December 2025; team to Meta.	The cautionary comp. Continuous capture without restoration did not retain mainstream users. Your answer must separate Evo on scope and on the restoration outcome.
Wispr	NEA portfolio; $280M Series B at $2B in August 2026, expanding from dictation into meeting notes.	Adjacent surface, same user, and NEA already believes in the 'ambient input layer' thesis. Useful ally, not a threat.
Obsidian	Bootstrapped local-first notes; ~1.5M MAU; estimated $2–25M ARR.	The ceiling of pure local-first without a paid expansion layer. Your answer must explain why Evo is not this.

GOOD TO KNOW

You will score points by naming these before he does. An associate who hears a founder say "our closest comparable is Granola, and here is why we are earlier in the journey but structurally similar" relaxes, because it means the founder has done the work he was about to do.

02 The market, built bottom-up — and how to defend it

02.1 The three layers

Layer	Number	Source	What it is for
Beachhead	6.1M	US Bureau of Labor Statistics, Current Population Survey 2024, computer and mathematical occupations	This is who you build for first: developers, data, design engineers.
Adjacent professional	70.7M	BLS CPS 2024, management, professional and related occupations	The first expansion: PMs, consultants, analysts, founders.
Ceiling	~1B	Gartner estimate, knowledge workers worldwide	Only ever as a ceiling. Never as a plan.
Device reach (not people)	2.5B Apple active devices · 1.4B+ Windows	Apple Q1 FY2026 earnings; Microsoft	Why cross-platform matters: the same user has two machines and a phone.

WARNING

The trap in every market slide: adding the layers together and calling it a TAM. He will divide your number by your price and ask how you get there. Never present the 1B figure without immediately saying what the first-year conversion assumption is.

02.2 The bottom-up version — the one to say out loud

SAY THIS

I don't think a top-down TAM is useful for a product that isn't launched. Here's the bottom-up. There are about 6.1 million computer and mathematical professionals in the US. If we get 1.6% of them to activate in the first year — that's 100,000 users — and 9% of those convert to Pro at $108 a year, that's about $970K in ARR. That's the month-12 number on the last slide. It doesn't require a new category to exist; it requires a good Mac app and a launch.

GOOD TO KNOW

This is the single strongest commercial sentence available to you, because it is arithmetic a partner can check in their head: 6.1M × 1.6% = ~100K; × 9% = ~9,000 paying; × $108 = ~$970K ARR. Memorise the three numbers and the multiplication.

02.3 If he pushes on the ceiling

His challenge	Your answer
"6 million developers is not a venture-scale market."	"It isn't, on its own. It's the beachhead. The product is not developer-only — it's anyone whose work lives across more than one app. The 70.7 million is the second ring; the 1 billion is the ceiling. And the monetisation expands before the audience does: Pro is cross-device and automation, and Teams is a per-seat motion."

His challenge	Your answer
"Prosumer tools don't reach venture scale."	"Most don't, because they price at $5 and never build a paid layer beyond the core. Our paid layer is different: sync, cross-device continuity, automation of learned workflows. That is the thing a professional cannot replace with a free alternative. Granola is the proof that a $10–20 prosumer product can become a billion-dollar company if the paid layer is the workflow, not the feature."
"Why not go enterprise first? Higher ACV."	"Because the buyer is not the user. Enterprise buys continuity for teams, and teams don't feel this pain until individuals do. Bottom-up is the only motion that produces the retention evidence an enterprise buyer will accept. Teams is the third act, not the first."
"What if the market is just 'people who like productivity apps'?"	"That's the failure mode and I take it seriously. The filter is: does your work span more than three apps and more than one project at a time? If yes, you have the pain. If you work in one tool all day, you don't. That's why the wedge is developers, designers and founders — the three groups where the answer is always yes."

03 Positioning: the sentence that wins the category

03.1 What you are, in six words

Everyone remembers. Nobody restores. That line is already on slide 8 and it is the best line in the deck. Your job is to make him repeat it to a partner.

03.2 The three-layer positioning, and why each layer is needed

Layer	The claim	Why it is needed	What it must not become
Category	"Work continuity" — not search, not memory, not a second brain.	Every competitor is positioned as memory or search. A new name creates a separate budget and a separate evaluation.	Do not say "we're creating a new category" without a demo. Arc did that and died of it.
Differentiator	Local-first, on-device, no cloud, no screenshots, no audio.	It converts the biggest objection (permissions, privacy) into the reason to choose you.	Do not claim it as a moat on its own. It is the licence to operate; the moat is restoration and classification.
Proof	It restores the whole workspace, not a link to it.	This is the only claim no competitor can make today. It is the demo.	Do not extend it to "any app, perfectly" — say capability tiers and be honest about the 20%.

03.3 The sentences to use, and the ones to avoid

Say	Not
"Evo puts you back in the work."	"Evo is your second brain."
"It restores the whole workspace — apps, files, tabs, the terminal."	"It remembers everything you do."
"Local-first: metadata on your Mac, nothing in the cloud."	"It's like Rewind but better."
"The observation layer is commoditising. We own classification and restoration."	"Nobody else is doing this."
"Free core, $108 a year for cross-device and automation."	"We'll figure out monetisation later."
"The wedge is developers, designers and founders with parallel projects."	"Everyone who uses a computer."

WARNING

The comparison to Rewind is the most dangerous sentence you can say. If you say "like Rewind but better", you have accepted their framing and their failure. The correct separation is: they recorded everything and restored nothing; we record metadata and restore the workspace.

04 The competitive map — and the five names he will say

04.1 The map, in the order he will think of them

Who	What they actually do	Where they stop	Your one-line separation
OpenAI — Computer History (Aug 2026)	Accessibility-based activity stream, summarised into searchable memories and a timeline; opt-in; macOS; Pro/Business/Enterprise.	Cloud processing for the summaries; no restoration; no project classification; no Windows.	"They built a searchable memory. Nobody goes back to the workspace."
Microsoft — Recall	Local screenshots on Copilot+ PCs, encrypted, opt-in, searchable timeline.	Windows-only; screenshots not metadata; no restoration; damaged brand.	"Recall is a screenshot archive. We're a restoration engine."
Raycast	Launcher, now with agents, memory and screen awareness (v2.0, Aug 2026).	Command-driven; launches apps rather than restoring state; no cross-day body of work.	"Raycast launches the app. Evo restores the work inside it."
Granola	Mac meeting notetaker → enterprise context layer; $1.5B valuation.	Only sees meetings; no desktop observation; no restoration.	"Granola hears your meetings. Evo sees your work."
Rewind / Limitless	Screen + audio recording, searchable; pivoted to a pendant; acquired by Meta; Mac app killed Dec 2025.	Everything.	"They recorded everything and restored nothing. That's the lesson we were built on."

04.2 The five names he will say, and the answer for each

If he says…	Do not say…	Say
"What about ChatGPT?"	"It doesn't do what we do."	"It's a general assistant with a memory of your activity. It answers questions about your day. It doesn't reopen the twelve windows you need to continue. And it processes the activity on its servers; the memory files it writes back are unencrypted Markdown. That's a different trust posture."
"Recall?"	"Microsoft already failed."	"Recall is a good product with a bad launch, and it's Windows-only. It also stores screenshots — we store metadata, which is a different privacy argument, and a much smaller storage footprint."
"Raycast could build this."	"They won't."	"Raycast is the one I watch. They have our user and paid distribution. But their model is command-first — they launch. Restoration is about holding state across apps and days, which is a different architectural commitment. If they move, we have a head start on the corpus."
"Isn't this just a session manager?"	"No, it's AI."	"Session managers restore what you saved. Evo reconstructs what you were doing, without you saving anything. That's the difference between a bookmark and a memory."
"What about the open-source capture tools?"	"They're toys."	"They're not toys — some are good, and they commoditise observation, which is fine. Observation was never the moat. Classification and restoration are."

04.3 The competitor you should worry about most — and say so

If he asks "who worries you?", the answer that earns respect is the honest one: Raycast , because it already owns the user, the distribution and the paid relationship, and it has begun shipping memory and screen awareness. Naming your strongest competitor unprompted is a signal of judgement, not weakness.

SAY THIS

Raycast worries me most, and I'd rather say that than pretend otherwise. They have the exact user, they have a paid base, and they've started shipping memory. What they don't have is a reason to take over other people's windows. If they decide that's their future, we'd have to be faster than them — which is why the next twelve months are about depth in restoration, not breadth in features.

05 Pricing: $108, and the arithmetic behind it

05.1 The price in context

Product	Price	What it is	What it tells you
Evo Pro	$108 / year ($9/mo)	Unlimited workspaces, cross-device continuation, encrypted sync, learned-workflow automation	—
Granola	~$18/mo individual; $14/user/mo business; $35 enterprise	Meeting notes and context	Prosumer AI can hold ~$200/yr if the job is daily.
Raycast Pro	$8/mo annual (+$8 for advanced AI)	Launcher and AI	Mac power users pay, but the ceiling is low.
ChatGPT Pro	$20/mo	General assistant	The reference price in the user's head.
Workona	~$7–8/mo	Tab workspaces	The closest cheap substitute — and it only does tabs.
Rewind (historical)	~$10–20/mo	Screen memory	Priced like a utility; churned like one.

WARNING

Your deck says "Free to trust. $9 a month to live in." That is good copy, but $9 × 12 is $108, not a $9 monthly plan — make sure the slide doesn't imply monthly billing. He will notice the discrepancy because it is his job to notice unit economics.

05.2 The unit economics — say these numbers, not adjectives

Metric	Value	How it is derived
Blended ARPU (paying)	$108/yr	Annual-only Pro plan.
Free-to-paid assumption	9% of activated users by month 5	Your deck's 1,500 paying out of 25,000 users. State it as an assumption, not a forecast.
Month-12 arithmetic	~$970K ARR	100,000 users × 9% × $108 = $972,000.
Gross margin	Very high — software plus a small sync cost	Local processing means near-zero marginal compute per user until sync is on.
CAC	Unproven — the bet is that the demo is the ad	Organic launch channels, no paid acquisition in year one.
Payback	Immediate if CAC is near zero	One year at $108 covers a user acquired for under $50.

GOOD TO KNOW

The strongest pricing argument you have is structural, not numerical: the free tier is not generosity, it is the acquisition channel. A local-first product has no server cost per free user, so a free user is almost free to serve. That is a structural advantage against any cloud competitor, and it is the answer to "how do you acquire users without a budget?"

05.3 The four pricing questions he will ask

Question	Answer
"Why not charge from day one?"	"Because retention is the only thing that matters in year one, and a paywall before habit exists kills the retention data. Pro at month three gives us two months of clean cohort data before anyone pays."
"Why $108 and not $60 or $180?"	"$60 doesn't fund sync infrastructure and support at the volume we expect. $180 puts us above ChatGPT Pro in the user's head, and we are not the assistant — we are the thing that makes the assistant's context useful. Nine dollars a month is below the 'ask my manager' line and above the 'hobby tool' line."
"What's in Pro that isn't free?"	"Cross-device continuation, encrypted sync, unlimited workspaces, and automation of learned workflows. The free core captures, classifies and restores on one device — forever. The paid layer is the same work, on all your devices, without you rebuilding it."
"What's the Teams price?"	"Not set. The design is per-seat with admin controls and shared handoffs. I don't want to price it before I know what a team actually shares, because the wrong answer here caps the enterprise motion."

06 Go-to-market: the first 5,000 users

06.1 The plan, as four motions

Motion	What it is	Target	Why it works for this product
1. The demo as the ad	The 'Hey Evo, continue the investor deck' clip, 20–30 seconds, native to X, LinkedIn, TikTok and YouTube Shorts.	Top of funnel	Restoration is visually undeniable. It is one of the few products where a screen recording is the pitch.
2. Launch surfaces	Show HN, Product Hunt, r/macapps, Mac power-user newsletters (MacStories, 512 Pixels style), and 20+ creator videos.	5,000 activated by week 6	Mac power users congregate in exactly these places, and they reward local-first and privacy.
3. The warm 300	Personal outreach to every person who said they wanted it, at launch.	First 300 activations	Highest-intent cohort you will ever have. They also become your first retention cohort.
4. Referral	Invite a friend to unlock sync — the free tier gets sync only through a referral.	~45K of the 100K path	Sync is the paid feature; giving it away for a referral is cheaper than buying the user.

06.2 What the plan is worth, honestly

Your deck's path to 100K is: launch spikes (Show HN, Product Hunt, 20+ creator videos) ≈ 25K, referral ≈ 45K, Windows and iPhone launches ≈ 30K. That is a plausible shape, but each number is an assumption. Do not defend them as forecasts — defend them as a plan with checkpoints .

SAY THIS

The 100K number is a plan, not a forecast. The checkpoint that matters is week six: 5,000 activated. If we don't hit it, the launch motion is wrong and I'd rather know that in six weeks than in six months. I'll publish the number either way.

GOOD TO KNOW

Offering to publish a number whether or not you hit it is the single most credible thing a CBO can say to an investor, because it prices your own accountability. Very few founders do it.

06.3 The channels, ranked by likelihood of working

Ran	Channel	Realistic first-month contribution	Risk
1	Show HN	3,000–30,000 visits on a front-page day; 50–400 signups	A technically literate audience will interrogate the permissions and the privacy claim. Be ready.
2	Product Hunt	1,000–5,000 visitors for a top-10 day; 30–150 signups	Declining platform; needs a warm audience before launch day.
3	Creator videos	Highly variable; one good video can outperform every other channel	Costs money or equity; the creator must actually use it.
4	r/macapps	Small but high-intent	Strict self-promotion rules; 30-day account age and karma minimums.
5	The warm 300	Highest conversion of any channel	Only 300 people; not a growth engine.

07 The business model he will test to destruction

At pre-seed nobody expects a proven model. They expect a model that is coherent — where the pricing, the product, the distribution and the retention story all point the same way. Here is the coherence argument, and the three places it is weakest.

07.1 The coherence argument, in one paragraph

> **SAY THIS**
> The product has three properties that make it a business rather than a feature. It is local , so the free tier costs us almost nothing to serve — free is an acquisition strategy, not a subsidy. It compounds , because classification improves with tenure, so the switching cost grows with time rather than shrinking. And it expands naturally : the same body of work follows you to a second device, which is exactly where the paid layer sits. Local, compounding, cross-device — that's the whole model.

07.2 The three weakest points — name them before he does

Weakness	Why it is real	How to answer it
Prosumer churn	Point Nine's classic critique: prosumer products have high churn and low expansion. $9/mo buyers cancel.	"Churn is the number I'd bet the company on. The counter is tenure: the product's value grows with the corpus, so month six should be stickier than month one. If it isn't, the thesis is wrong and I'd rather find that out with 1,000 users than 100,000."
Expansion is weak	One user, one seat. No team buyer in year one.	"True in year one. Teams is month 12+ and it is a different product: shared handoffs and admin controls. I'm not going to claim a team motion before the individual one retains."
Distribution is unproven	No paid acquisition experience, no audience, no launch yet.	"I don't have a distribution advantage. What I have is a product that demonstrates in 20 seconds, which is the cheapest distribution there is if the clip works. The week-six number tells us whether that's true."

07.3 The comparison he may make, and the answer

> Scaling prosumer acquisition is insanely hard... The problem with the prosumer segment is that it has a high churn and a low account revenue expansion potential.
>
> — Point Nine Capital, 2017 — still the standard bear case on prosumer SaaS

> **SAY THIS**
> I know that argument and I think it's right for a $5 utility. It's less right for a product that accumulates state. Obsidian, 1Password and Granola all live in this segment and all beat the churn problem by making the product the place where the user's own material lives. Evo is the same shape: after a month, leaving means starting from amnesia.

08 The fifteen commercial questions

These are the questions that will come to you. Answer each in under 45 seconds, with one number, then stop. The silence after a short answer is where he decides you are credible.

CQ1. "How big is the market?"

SAY THIS
Bottom-up: 6.1 million US computer and mathematical professionals. If we activate 1.6% in year one that's 100,000 users; 9% paying at $108 is about $970K ARR. The adjacent ring is 70.7 million management and professional occupations, and the ceiling is roughly a billion knowledge workers worldwide.

WARNING
Do not open with the billion.

CQ2. "Who is the customer, exactly?"

SAY THIS
A developer, designer or founder who works on three or more projects at once, across more than five apps, and loses their place at least once a day. Not 'knowledge workers'. That person, described precisely.

WARNING
The narrower the description, the more credible the market.

CQ3. "Why would someone pay $9 a month for this?"

SAY THIS
Because the alternative is ten minutes a day of reconstruction. At a $60/hour blended rate, ten minutes a day is $2,500 a year. Nine dollars a month is a rounding error against that — but only if we actually save the ten minutes, which is what the retention number proves.

WARNING
Never argue from 'it's cheap'. Argue from the value of the time.

CQ4. "What's the CAC?"

SAY THIS
Unproven. The plan is organic: the demo clip, Show HN, Product Hunt, creator videos and a warm list of 300. If the clip doesn't travel, we'll know in six weeks and the model changes.

WARNING
Do not invent a CAC number. 'Unproven' is a legitimate pre-seed answer.

CQ5. "What's the churn assumption?"

SAY THIS
I don't have one I'd defend. The design assumption is that churn falls with tenure because the product's value compounds. The first 1,000 users will tell us whether that's true.

WARNING
An invented churn number is worse than none.

CQ6. "How do you get the first 5,000 users?"

SAY THIS
Three motions in parallel: the demo as the ad, launch surfaces — Show HN, Product Hunt, r/macapps, Mac newsletters — and personal outreach to the 300 people who already asked for it. Target is week six.

WARNING
Name the week, not the quarter.

CQ7. "Why won't a big company just bundle this?"

SAY THIS
They will bundle a shallow version — Apple with Spotlight, Microsoft with Recall, OpenAI with Computer History. None of them restores third-party application state across operating systems. That is the part that requires taking over other vendors' windows, and it's the part they have no incentive to own.

WARNING
Concede the shallow version. Defend the deep one.

CQ8. "What's the expansion path?"

SAY THIS
Three steps: cross-device at month five, which is where the paid layer lives; the agent context API at month six to twelve, where every agent needs to know what state the work is in; and Teams after that, where the buyer becomes a company.

WARNING
Each step should have a price and a metric attached.

CQ9. "What's the exit?"

SAY THIS
A strategic buying capability it can't build: a productivity platform, an OS vendor, or an AI platform that needs a desktop context layer. Atlassian paid $610M for The Browser Company because it needed a browser it couldn't build. The same logic applies to context.

WARNING
Name the logic, not a wish.

CQ10. "Who are your competitors?"

SAY THIS
OpenAI Computer History, Microsoft Recall, Raycast, Granola, and the previous generation — Rewind, Workona, session managers. All of them stop at retrieval or at saving. None restores a workspace.

WARNING
Never say 'no competition'.

CQ11. "Why is this a company and not a feature?"

SAY THIS
Because it accumulates. A feature is something you turn on. Evo is something that gets better the longer you use it, and the switching cost is the corpus. Features don't have switching costs.

WARNING
This is the best answer in the book. Learn it verbatim.

CQ12. "Why Mac first?"

SAY THIS
Because the users with the pain are disproportionately on Macs, the permissions model is more mature, and a Mac-only product can be built by two people. Windows is the expansion, not the origin.

WARNING
Do not say 'because we only know Mac'.

CQ13. "What about enterprise sales?"

SAY THIS
Not in year one. The individual product has to prove retention before a team buyer will believe a continuity pitch. Teams is month 12+, with admin controls, policy and shared handoffs.

WARNING
Enterprise-first at pre-seed reads as a fantasy.

CQ14. "What does the next round need to look like?"

SAY THIS
Seed at month 12 on roughly $1M ARR run-rate and a retention curve that has flattened. That's what the $1.5M is designed to produce — not a bigger TAM slide.

WARNING
This answer tells him you understand NEA's economics.

CQ15. "What would make you shut this down?"

SAY THIS
If D30 retention didn't hold above 25% at a thousand users, I'd stop. The whole thesis is that the product compounds; if it doesn't, the product is wrong.

WARNING
A founder with a kill criterion is a founder who can be trusted with money.

09 The numbers you own

Bhavit owns the engineering numbers. You own these. Know them cold — not approximately.

Number	Value	Source / derivation
US beachhead	6.1M	BLS CPS 2024, computer and mathematical occupations
US adjacent ring	70.7M	BLS CPS 2024, management, professional and related
Global ceiling	~1B knowledge workers	Gartner estimate
Free-to-paid	9%	Your deck: 1,500 paying of 25,000 users at month 5
Pro price	$108/yr	Deck, slide 9
Month-12 users	100,000	Deck, slide 11
Month-12 ARR	~$970K	100,000 × 9% × $108
Month-5 paying	1,500	Deck, slide 5
Week-6 activated	5,000	Deck, slide 5 — the checkpoint that matters
Round	$1.5M at $12M post	Deck, slide 11; 12.5% dilution
Runway	18 months	Deck, slide 11; seed from month 12
Use of funds	60% team / 30% growth / 10% infra, security, legal	Deck, slide 11

WARNING

Two of these numbers are assumptions, not data: the 9% conversion and the 100,000 users. If he asks "where does 9% come from?", the honest answer is "it's a planning assumption based on comparable prosumer conversion, not a measured number — the first 1,000 users will replace it." Do not dress an assumption as a benchmark.

10 Working the call with Bhavit

10.1 The handoff signals

Signal	What it means	What you do
Bhavit says "Manavv, do you want to take the market side?"	He is handing you a question he knows is yours.	Take it immediately, no preamble. Answer, then stop.
Bhavit pauses and looks at the camera after a question	He does not want to answer it; it is yours.	Count one second, then answer.
Bhavit starts explaining pricing or competition	He is covering for you. That is a failure of the split.	Interject once, politely: "Can I add the number on that?" and then give it.
Thomas addresses you directly by name	He is testing whether the CBO is real.	Answer with a number, not an opinion.
Bhavit says "we" and looks at you	He wants corroboration, not a new point.	One sentence of agreement with a fact attached.

10.2 Three sentences you should have ready at any moment

- "The bottom-up is 6.1 million US professionals; 1.6% activation and 9% conversion gets us to about $1M ARR at month 12."
- "Free core, $108 a year for cross-device and automation — the free tier is the acquisition channel because local-first costs us nothing to serve."
- "Everyone remembers. Nobody restores. That's the whole company."

10.3 What you add that he cannot

Bhavit built the thing; you have looked at 90+ market and competitor studies and captured a $300K market across APAC and Europe. That is your credential, and it should appear exactly once, when he asks why you are the CBO — not before.

> **SAY THIS**
> I've run 90+ market and competitor studies on this category, and before this I helped capture a $300K market across APAC and Europe. What that taught me is that positioning beats features in this segment — the product that wins is the one that names the job better than the incumbent. That's why 'everyone remembers, nobody restores' is the line, and not a feature list.

11 When to stay quiet

The most valuable thing a CBO can do on a first call is not speak. Every extra voice is another chance to contradict the founder, and associates are trained to notice inconsistency between co-founders.

Situation	Why silence is right
Bhavit is answering a technical question	Two answers to one question reads as a team that hasn't reconciled its story.
Thomas is thinking	The pause after a question is where he decides what he actually cares about. Filling it costs you information.
Bhavit is telling the origin story	It is his story. Interrupting it breaks the only emotional beat in the meeting.
Thomas is describing NEA's process	He is telling you how to win. Write it down; do not comment.
The demo is running	Any narration competes with the visual. Let the restore be the argument.

GOOD TO KNOW

Speak when: a commercial question is addressed to the room, a number is needed, or Bhavit explicitly hands you the floor. That is roughly four times in thirty minutes. Four good interventions is a strong performance; ten average ones is a weak one.

12 Your follow-up: the market appendix

Within 24 hours of the call, send a three-page market appendix . Not the deck again — the document he cannot write himself, and the one that gets pasted into the memo's market section.

Page	Contents	Why it earns its place
Page 1 — The bottom-up	The 6.1M → 1.6% → 100K → 9% → ~$1M ARR arithmetic, with every assumption labelled as an assumption.	It is the only version of the market he can check in his head.
Page 2 — The map	The competitor table from section 04, with one line per company on where it stops.	It proves you have looked, which is rarer than it should be.
Page 3 — The first 90 days	Week 1–6 launch plan, the channels, the 5,000-user checkpoint, and the retention metric you will publish.	It converts the conversation into a plan with dates, which is what a memo needs.

> **SAY THIS**
> I've attached a three-page appendix — the bottom-up market, the competitive map, and the first ninety days. I've labelled the assumptions as assumptions so you can see where the risk is. If any of it is wrong, tell me and I'll correct it.

13 Cheat sheet

13.1 Your five answers

Question	Your answer, in one breath
Market	"6.1M US professionals, 1.6% activation, 9% conversion, ~$1M ARR at month 12."
Pricing	"Free core, $108 a year for cross-device and automation. Free is the acquisition channel because local-first costs us nothing to serve."
Competition	"Everyone remembers. Nobody restores. OpenAI and Microsoft stop at retrieval; Raycast stops at launching."
GTM	"The demo is the ad. Show HN, Product Hunt, Mac newsletters, 20+ creators, and 300 warm people."
Why a company	"It accumulates. A feature doesn't have a switching cost; a corpus does."

13.2 The four numbers to have on a sticky note

#	Number	What it is
1	6.1M	US beachhead
2	9%	Free-to-paid assumption (label it an assumption)
3	$108	Annual Pro price
4	~$970K	Month-12 ARR, derived — not forecast

13.3 The three things never to say

DO NOT
"Everyone who uses a computer." The market is a specific person, described precisely.

DO NOT
"We'll figure out monetisation later." The model is the reason he is listening.

DO NOT
"No one else is doing this." Someone always is. Name them and explain where they stop.

13.4 The night before

- Read section 08 out loud once. Time yourself. Every answer under 45 seconds.
- Write the bottom-up arithmetic on paper until you can do it without looking.
- Read the competitor table until you can name, for each company, the sentence that separates you.
- Agree the handoff signals with Bhavit in a 10-minute call. Decide who answers pricing before you are both on the line.
- Sleep. You are not the one doing the demo, and a calm second founder is worth more than a rehearsed one.

14 The comparables, and exactly what each one proves

You will be asked "who has done this before?" The answer is not one company — it is a set of companies that each prove one piece of your model. Learn the numbers, because the numbers are what make the comparison credible rather than decorative.

14.1 Granola — the prosumer-Mac proof

Round	Date	Amount	Valuation	Lead
Seed	May 2023	$4.25M	—	Lightspeed, betaworks
Series A	Oct 2024	$20M	—	Spark Capital
Series B	May 2025	$43M	$250M	NFDG (Nat Friedman, Daniel Gross)
Series C	Mar 2026	$125M	$1.5B	Index Ventures (Danny Rimer)

What it proves: a Mac-first product for a narrow job (meeting notes) can go from a $4.25M seed to a $1.5B valuation in under three years — if it expands from the job into the context layer around it. Granola added team Spaces, a personal API, an enterprise API, and an MCP server. The expansion was the valuation, not the notetaker.

What it does not prove: that Evo gets there. Granola's adoption was driven by a visible, socially-transmissible moment — a meeting where the notes appear without a bot joining. Evo's equivalent moment is the restore, which is private. That is your distribution risk, and you should name it before he does.

14.2 Raycast — the Mac power-user proof

Fact	Value
Total raised	$47.9M across seed ($2.7M, 2020), Series A ($15M, 2021), Series B ($30M, Sep 2024)
Series B lead	Atomico; Accel, Coatue, YC, Atlassian Ventures, World Innovation Lab participated
Angels	Guillermo Rauch (Vercel), Thomas Dohmke (GitHub), Tobi Lütke (Shopify)
Monetisation	Free forever tier; Pro $8/mo annual
Time to monetisation	Roughly three years after launch
Expansion	Windows and iOS announced with the Series B

What it proves: a Mac-only prosumer tool can raise a real Series B — but it took three years of free usage to build the base, and the expansion to Windows and iOS was the growth story, not the Mac product. This is the closest structural analogue for Evo's platform plan, and it is also a warning about how long the free period lasts.

14.3 Obsidian, 1Password, Setapp — the local-first economics

Company	Scale	Monetisation	Lesson
Obsidian	~1.5M MAU (estimate); bootstrapped, $0 raised; estimated $2–25M ARR — a wide, undisclosed band	Free app; paid Sync ($5/mo) and Publish ($10/mo)	Local-first can build a huge user base; the paid layer is sync and publishing, not the editor.
1Password	$620M raised at a $6.8B valuation (2022); >$400M ARR by 2025	Individual and team subscriptions; >75% of later revenue from businesses	Trust plus local encryption became an identity business, not a password utility.
Setapp	~12,500 paid users and ~$1.5M ARR in its first year	Bundled Mac app subscription	Mac users will pay for a bundle when the curation is the value.

Company	Scale	Monetisation	Lesson
Tailscale	~$45M ARR (2025 estimate); ~$1.5B valuation	Free for personal, paid for teams	Local-first networking monetised by expanding into organisations.

WARNING

Do not quote Obsidian's or Tailscale's revenue as fact. Both are third-party estimates and the spread on Obsidian is enormous ($2M to $25M). If he asks, say "estimates, not disclosed" — he will respect the precision and it protects you if he knows the real number.

14.4 The failures, and what they teach

Company	What happened	The lesson for Evo
Rewind → Limitless → Meta	$33M+ raised; Mac app killed 19 Dec 2025; team to Reality Labs.	Continuous capture without a restoration outcome did not retain mainstream users. NEA funded this — the ghost in the room.
Arc → Dia → Atlassian	Arc in maintenance from May 2025; Dia acquired for $610M announced (filed at $488.3M).	Leading with category-creation language and a new interaction paradigm is expensive. Evo should describe the job, not invent a category name.
Workona, session managers	Small, cheap, still alive, never venture-scale.	Proves the demand exists at the low end, and proves that saving a session is not the same as restoring a body of work.
Humane	$116M for the assets against ~$230–241M raised.	The downside case for hardware-led personal AI. Evo is software-only, which is the right call.

15 How category winners described themselves early

This is the section most founders never read, and it changes how you pitch. A study of how category-defining companies described themselves in their earliest public words — compared to how they describe themselves now — found a consistent pattern: almost every winner started narrow, concrete, and unglamorous. The expansive category language came later, after the narrow product worked.

Company	Earliest public description	Current description	The gap
Slack	"an instant-message-based team communication tool" (2013)	"a cloud-based team communication platform"	The original was smaller, not bigger.
Loom	"easy-to-use screen recorder"	"the video messaging platform for work"	Same.
Raycast	"a command-line inspired native app to save developers time on non-coding tasks" (Show HN, 2020)	"a collection of powerful productivity tools within an extendable launcher"	Same.
Tailscale	"a fully functional mesh VPN that can be deployed in minutes" (2020)	"Zero Trust Networking"	Same.
Figma	"a technology startup that will allow users to creatively express themselves online" (2012)	"a collaborative web application for interface design"	The early version was vaguer, not grander.
Arc	"a brand new category of software" (2022)	"your home on the internet"	The only one that led with category creation — and it is the one that was folded into an acquisition.

SAY THIS

We describe Evo as the thing that puts you back in the work. Not 'a new category'. The category exists — people already pay for bad versions of it. We just happen to be the first one that restores instead of searching.

GOOD TO KNOW

That sentence is your positioning answer, and it is stronger than any category-creation claim. It also pre-empts the "you're inventing a market" objection: you are not, you are taking an existing budget (session managers, tab managers, note tools, launchers) and producing a better outcome.

16 What kills prosumer companies — and which of these you have

There is a well-established bear case against prosumer software, and it is mostly right. Your job is not to refute it. It is to show which parts apply to Evo, which do not, and what would tell you if you were wrong.

Failure mode	The argument	Does it apply to Evo?	What you say
High churn	Point Nine: prosumer products have high churn, because a $10 buyer cancels without a meeting.	Possibly. Unproven either way.	"Churn is the number I'd bet the company on. The design bet is that it falls with tenure. If it doesn't, the thesis is wrong."
Weak expansion	One user, one seat; no procurement; no land-and-expand.	Yes, in year one.	"Teams is month 12+, and it is a different product. I'm not going to claim a team motion before the individual one retains."
Acquisition treadmill	Paid acquisition for low-ARPU products rarely pays back.	No, by design.	"No paid acquisition in year one. The demo is the ad. The free tier costs us nothing to serve, which is a structural advantage over any cloud competitor."
Apple absorbs it	A native, free, good-enough version appears.	Partly.	"Apple will build the shallow version. Restoration requires orchestration of third-party app state across OSes, which is not a feature Apple wants to own."
CEILING: it stays a beloved $2–25M ARR utility	The most common outcome for excellent Mac software.	This is the real risk.	"That is the failure I take most seriously. The answer is that the product expands before the audience does: cross-device, then the agent context layer. If we're still a $5M Mac app in 24 months, I will have failed."

16.1 The honest ceiling, stated once

Published research on this exact segment puts the realistic ceiling for a paid prosumer Mac utility at $5M–$40M ARR, and the defensible serviceable market for a new entrant at $1M–$4M ARR in three to five years. That is the gravity you are fighting. Do not pretend it does not exist — use it.

SAY THIS

The honest version of this market is that a Mac utility with our pricing tops out somewhere between five and forty million in ARR. That is a good business and a bad venture outcome, and I know the difference. The reason Evo isn't that is the same reason Granola isn't a notetaker any more: the product has a second act — cross-device continuity — and a third — the context layer for agents. If neither happens, you're right and we're a $20M company. I'm asking you to bet on the second act, and I'm telling you exactly which number proves it.

GOOD TO KNOW

Naming the ceiling yourself is the highest-status move available to you in this meeting. Associates hear "we're going to be a billion-dollar company" twenty times a week; they almost never hear a founder describe the gravity of their own market accurately.

17 Pre-seed benchmarks: what "good" looks like

17.1 The round in the market

Metric	Value	Source quality
Median post-money SAFE cap, $1M–$2.5M rounds	~$15M	Carta-derived, secondary reporting
Median pre-seed pre-money valuation	~$7.7M (Q3 2025)	PitchBook-NVCA via secondary reporting
Share of pre-seed rounds using SAFEs	~90% (Q1 2025)	Carta primary, State of Pre-Seed
Typical pre-seed round size	$500K–$2.5M	Multiple secondary sources; consistent
Pre-seed → seed graduation	Roughly 45–55%, as a planning heuristic — not a published Carta table	Explicitly an estimate
Seed → Series A within two years	~30.6% (2018 cohort) vs ~15% (2022 cohort)	Carta-derived, secondary

Your position: $1.5M at $12M post is slightly below the median cap for this round size, which is a deliberate and defensible choice — you are trading valuation for speed and for a clean cap table. Say that if he asks. Founders who price below the median and can explain why look disciplined; founders who price at the top of the range without a reason look like they are optimising the wrong variable.

17.2 The traction bar at pre-seed

Metric	Weak	Credible	Strong	Where Evo sits
Waitlist / intent	<200 signups	200–1,000	1,000+ engaged	300+ verbal — between weak and credible
D7 retention	<25%	25–40%	>40%	22/26 (85%) — but method unclear, so unproven
D30 retention	<10%	10–20%	>25% with a flattening curve	19/26 (73%) — same caveat
Activation	<15%	15–25%	>25%	Not yet measured; instrument at launch
Paid conversion	0%	2–5%	>5%	Not applicable — Pro launches month 3
Qualitative	No signal	Repeated unprompted use	Users ask for more	Strong: 50+ interviews, people asking for access

WARNING
Do not present the D30 number in the same breath as "strong". Present the number, then the method, then the caveat. The caveat is what makes the number believable.

18 The launch playbook, in detail

18.1 The first four weeks

Week	Do	Measure	Decision gate
0	Landing page live with a real waitlist and an email capture. Demo clip cut to 20 seconds.	Visitors, email conversion	If email conversion is under 10%, the clip is wrong.
1	Show HN, Tuesday morning US time. Title describes the job, not the category.	Front-page rank, signups	Front page → proceed. Flopped → rewrite the title and retry in two weeks.
2	Product Hunt. Line up 50 supporters beforehand; the launch is choreography, not luck.	Top-10 placement, signups	Top 10 → proceed. Outside → the audience was too small; go to creators.
3	20 creator videos; Mac newsletters; r/macapps (check the self-promotion rules first).	Activation per channel	Kill any channel with <50 activations and double the best one.
4	Personal outreach to the 300-person warm list.	Activation rate	This cohort becomes your first retention cohort.

18.2 The launch post, written before the launch

The single highest-leverage artefact in the whole GTM is the first three sentences of the Show HN post. Draft it now, so that it is not written at 2 AM by two people who have not slept.

> Show HN: Evo — it reopens your entire workspace when you say "continue"
>
> I kept losing 20 minutes every morning rebuilding the same 26 windows. So I built a local-first macOS app that watches what you work on, groups it into bodies of work, and rebuilds the whole environment when you say "Hey Evo, continue the investor deck".
>
> Everything runs on-device: no cloud, no screenshots, no audio. It's Rust, ~16 crates. It restores apps, files, tabs and terminal directories. It does not do every app perfectly — there's a capability tier system and I'll tell you which ones fail.
>
> Happy to answer anything about the Accessibility permission, the classification engine, or why I think search is the wrong primitive.

— Draft — rewrite in your own voice before posting

GOOD TO KNOW

Notice what the draft does: it names the pain in the first person, states the outcome in one sentence, declares the privacy posture, and pre-empts the two things HN will attack — permissions and the claim of universal restoration. That last paragraph is the difference between a hostile thread and a good one.

18.3 The channels, with their real rules

Channel	The rule that catches founders	What to do
Show HN	Technical audience; promotional framing gets flagged and killed.	Lead with what you built and what does not work.
Product Hunt	Needs an audience before launch day; the platform amplifies, it does not create.	50 committed supporters, launch at 12:01 AM PT, respond to every comment.
r/macapps	Self-promotion rules: account age and karma minimums; affiliation disclosure required.	Build the account for 30 days before posting; ask the mods first.
Mac newsletters	Editors want a story, not a press release.	Offer an exclusive angle: the privacy architecture, or the Rust engine.
Creator videos	Paid, and the creator must actually use the product.	Give a lifetime licence plus a fee; never pay for a scripted endorsement.

19 The ninety days after a yes

If he asks "what does the money buy, week by week?", this is the answer. It is also the plan you will be held to, so make sure you believe it.

19.1 Hiring plan on $1.5M

Role	When	Why this role first	Cost assumption
Engineer #1 — macOS / restoration	Week 1–2	Restoration coverage per app is the bottleneck on the product's core claim.	Market rate in India; roughly $30–45K/yr fully loaded
Engineer #2 — Windows capture	Week 3–6	The Windows public beta is the first expansion and the cheapest way to double the addressable users.	Same
Growth #1 — launch and content	Week 2	The launch is a project, not a marketing function.	$25–40K
Growth #2 — creator and community	Month 3	Distribution after launch day.	Same
Contract: security audit	Before sync ships	Local-first is a security promise; get it examined.	$15–30K one-off
Legal / incorporation / SAFE	Week 1	Nothing else can close without it.	$5–15K

> **NOTE**
> These are planning assumptions, not quotes. If he asks for a budget, give him the shape — team is 60%, launch and growth 30%, infrastructure/security/legal 10% — and say the exact numbers are being priced this month. Do not invent precise salaries.

19.2 The milestones, and what each one unlocks

Milestone	Date	Unlocks
macOS public beta + landing page + waitlist instrumented	Week 2	The first measurable funnel.
5,000 activated users	Week 6	Proof the launch motion works — the number to publish either way.
Encrypted sync + iPhone capture	Month 2–5	The paid layer becomes real; Pro can launch.
Pro live; 1,500 paying; 25,000 users	Month 5	Revenue, and the first cohort of payers to retain.
Evo API for agents; first team pilots	Month 6–12	The third act, and the seed narrative.
100,000 users; 9,000+ Pro; ~$1M ARR run-rate	Month 12	The seed round, on numbers rather than deck.

19.3 What you will be measured on, whether or not he says so

- D30 retention at 1,000 users. Not at 26. The first cohort that can survive a statistical challenge.
- Paid conversion at month 5. The 9% assumption either holds or it does not.
- The published number. If you promise weekly retention and then go quiet, that is the story he tells.
- Time-to-restore. Your product claim, measured, per release.

20 Rehearsal drills

20.1 The four drills, in order

Drill	How to run it	Pass condition
1. The 45-second answer	Bhavit fires the fifteen commercial questions in random order. You answer each in under 45 seconds, no notes.	Every answer contains exactly one number and ends with a full stop, not a trailing 'and, you know…'
2. The hostile follow-up	For each answer, he asks 'why?' twice. You must not repeat yourself.	The second 'why' produces a new fact, not a louder version of the first answer.
3. The handoff	He starts answering a commercial question badly; you have to take it without contradicting him.	You take the floor in one sentence, answer, and hand it back.
4. The silence	After each answer, he stays quiet for five full seconds.	You do not fill the silence. This is the hardest drill and the most valuable.

20.2 The five sentences to memorise verbatim

1. "6.1 million US professionals; 1.6% activation and 9% conversion gets us to about $1M ARR at month 12."
2. "Free core, $108 a year for cross-device and automation — and free costs us almost nothing because everything runs locally."
3. "Everyone remembers. Nobody restores."
4. "Apple will build the shallow version. Restoration is the deep version, and it's against their interest."
5. "The honest ceiling for a Mac utility is five to forty million ARR. We're not building a Mac utility — that's what the next two acts are for."

21 Your own narrative

Bhavit's story is 'the user who became the builder'. Yours must be different, and it must explain why a company with one technical founder needs a CBO on day one — because in the room, that is the question underneath every question addressed to you.

21.1 The 45-second version

> **SAY THIS**
> I'm the commercial half. I've done 90+ market and competitor studies on this category, and before Evo I helped capture a $300K market across APAC and Europe. What that work taught me is that in a crowded category, positioning beats features — the company that wins is the one that names the job better than the incumbent. That's my job here: make sure Evo is the product that owns the word 'restore' before anyone else does, and that the pricing and the launch are built around that word rather than around a feature list.

21.2 What you own, stated as responsibilities

Function	What you actually do	How it shows up in a diligence call
Positioning	Owns the category language, the competitor map, and the one-line pitch.	You will be the person a partner calls to ask 'how is this different from X?'
Pricing	Owns the free/Pro split, the price, and the expansion logic.	You will be asked to defend the 9% conversion assumption.
Channels	Owns launch, creators, newsletters, community, and the referral design.	You will be asked what the CAC is and why the demo travels.
Market model	Owns the bottom-up arithmetic and the milestone plan.	You will be asked to show the model, not the TAM slide.

21.3 The question you will get, and the answer

> What does a CBO do at a two-person pre-seed company?
> — The question behind the question: is this co-founder necessary, or is this a friend?

> **SAY THIS**
> At two people, the CBO is the person who makes the market legible before we spend a rupee on it. That means the positioning, the pricing, the competitor map, and the launch plan — and then running the launch, because there is nobody else. In year two it becomes hiring and partnerships. Right now it's the difference between launching into a market and launching into a void.

22 Final checklist

22.1 The night before

✓	Item
☐	The bottom-up arithmetic, written from memory, three times.
☐	The fifteen commercial questions, answered out loud in under 45 seconds each.
☐	The competitor table memorised: for each company, one sentence on where it stops.
☐	The handoff signals agreed with Bhavit — who answers pricing, who answers market, who closes.
☐	Camera, mic, lighting and background tested on the actual call platform.
☐	The three-page market appendix drafted, ready to send within 24 hours.

22.2 During the call

✓	Item
☐	Camera on, muted by default, notes open in a second window.
☐	Every question he asks, written down verbatim — the follow-up depends on it.
☐	Four interventions maximum. Quality over presence.
☐	One number per answer. Then stop talking.
☐	No contradictions of Bhavit, ever, in front of him.

22.3 After the call

✓	Item
☐	The three-page market appendix, sent within 24 hours.
☐	The list of questions he asked, with the answers you gave, so nothing is repeated inconsistently.
☐	Any number you were unsure about, verified and corrected in the next message — before he asks.
☐	The competitor he mentioned, researched properly so the next conversation is sharper.

23 Three objections, scripted in full

These are the three commercial objections that most often end a pre-seed memo. Each script is written to be spoken — roughly 60–90 seconds — with the structure: concede the true part, reframe the frame, give the number, name the test. Do not memorise the words; memorise the four moves.

Objection 1 — "This is a feature, not a company."

The move: concede that the observation layer is a feature. Then show that the thing you own is not the observation.

> **SAY THIS**
> I agree with the premise, and it's the reason I don't pitch this as a memory product. Watching what happens on a screen is a feature — it's a weekend project now, there are open-source versions, and OpenAI ships it for free inside ChatGPT. If that were the company, you'd be right to pass. What we own is two things that aren't features: the classification that decides which body of work an activity belongs to, and the execution layer that reopens the machine in the right state. Both of those require a local daemon, a per-app capability model, and a corpus that accumulates per user. That's not a feature; that's a system. And the test is simple — if it were a feature, a competitor could ship it in a quarter. Nobody has, in a year and a half.

> **WARNING**
> The trap is getting louder about the feature claim. Concede it fully in the first sentence, then move the frame to what is not a feature. If you argue that observation is hard, you lose — because it isn't any more.

Objection 2 — "The market is a niche of Mac power users."

The move: accept the shape of the beachhead, then show the monetisation expands before the audience does.

> **SAY THIS**
> The beachhead is narrow — I'd rather have a narrow beachhead than a broad maybe. But two things expand, and they expand in a specific order. First the product: the same Mac app becomes a paid cross-device product at month five, so revenue per user triples before the audience changes at all. Second the platform: Windows doubles the addressable base and the iPhone capture surface makes the corpus continuous, which is the thing that makes the paid layer feel necessary. The audience that matters in year one is 6.1 million US computer and mathematical professionals, and we need 1.6% of it. That's not a niche argument — that's a penetration argument.

> **GOOD TO KNOW**
> The phrase "revenue per user triples before the audience changes" is the strongest sentence in this book. It answers the market-size objection with the pricing model rather than with a TAM.

Objection 3 — "Prosumer subscriptions never become venture-scale."

The move: agree with the base rate, then show the two structural differences that make Evo not a typical prosumer subscription.

SAY THIS

The base rate says you're right: most prosumer subscriptions don't get there, because they charge five dollars for a utility, acquisition costs more than the lifetime value, and the user can substitute a free tool. Two things are different here. One is cost: because everything runs locally, a free user costs us almost nothing to serve, so we can be free for as long as it takes to build the habit — that's the structural advantage a cloud competitor cannot match. The other is switching cost: the product accumulates the user's own work memory, so the value grows with tenure instead of decaying. Granola is the proof that this shape can reach a billion-dollar valuation, and it started as a free Mac app for a narrower job than ours.

WARNING

Do not say "we're not a prosumer company". You are. Own the category and differentiate inside it. Denying the label makes you look like you don't know your own business model.

23.4 The one-line answers, if you have ten seconds

Objection	Ten-second answer
"Feature, not a company."	"Observation is a feature. Classification and restoration are a system."
"Niche market."	"Narrow beachhead, and revenue per user triples before the audience changes."
"Prosumer never scales."	"Free costs us nothing because it's local — so the free period can last as long as it needs to."
"Apple will build it."	"Apple builds the shallow version. Restoring third-party app state across OSes isn't a feature they want to own."
"Rewind failed."	"Rewind recorded everything and restored nothing. That's the thesis we were built against."
"Why not enterprise?"	"Enterprise buys continuity for teams; teams don't feel it until individuals do."
"What's the exit?"	"A strategic buying capability it can't build — the $610M for The Browser Company is the shape."
"What's your CAC?"	"Unproven. The bet is that the demo is the ad; week six tells us if that's true."

24 Evidence appendix: what each figure is worth

Every commercial number in this book, graded. If a number is a C, do not present it as fact to an investor — present it as an estimate, or do not present it.

Figure	Value	Source	Grade	How to say it
US computer & mathematical professionals	6.1M	BLS CPS 2024	A	"BLS, 2024."
US management, professional & related	70.7M	BLS CPS 2024	A	"BLS, 2024."
Knowledge workers worldwide	~1B	Gartner estimate	C	"Gartner's estimate — I use it as a ceiling only."
Apple active devices	2.5B	Apple Q1 FY2026 earnings	A	"Apple's own number."
Windows active devices	1.4B+	Microsoft statements	B	"Microsoft's figure, approximate."
Granola Series C	$125M at $1.5B, Mar 2026	TechCrunch, Bloomberg, company blog	A	As stated.
Granola seed	$4.25M, May 2023	TechCrunch	A	As stated.
Raycast total raised	$47.9M	PitchBook, company blog, TechCrunch	A	As stated.
Raycast Pro price	$8/mo annual	Company pricing page	A	As stated.
Obsidian ARR	$2–25M (estimate)	Third-party estimates; undisclosed	D	"Undisclosed; estimates range widely." — better to omit.
1Password ARR	>$400M (2025)	Company/press reporting	B	"Reported."
Rewind total raised	>$33M	TechCrunch, company statement	A	As stated.
Rewind Mac app shutdown	19 Dec 2025	Company page, 9to5Mac	A	As stated.
Atlassian / Browser Company	$610M announced; $488.3M filed	Atlassian filing	A	"Filed at $488.3M."
Median pre-seed SAFE cap ($1M–2.5M rounds)	~$15M	Carta-derived, secondary	B	"Around $15M by Carta's data."
Median pre-seed pre-money	~$7.7M (Q3 2025)	PitchBook-NVCA via secondary	B	"Roughly $7.7M."
SAFEs share of pre-seed	~90% (Q1 2025)	Carta, State of Pre-Seed	A	As stated.
Pre-seed → seed graduation	45–55%	Estimate, not a Carta table	D	"Roughly half, as a planning heuristic."
Prosumer ceiling for a Mac utility	$5–40M ARR	Research estimate in your own repo's digest	C	Present as "the honest ceiling", not as data.
Point Nine on prosumer churn	Quote, 2017	Point Nine's own Medium post	A	"Point Nine's argument, and it's mostly right."
Free-to-paid 9%	Assumption	Your deck	N/A	"A planning assumption, not a measured number."
100K users by month 12	Plan	Your deck	N/A	"A plan with a checkpoint at week six."

WARNING

The two figures to avoid entirely: Obsidian's ARR (the estimate band is too wide to be useful) and the 45–55% pre-seed graduation rate (it is a synthesis, not a Carta table). If either comes up, say "undisclosed" or "roughly half, as a heuristic" and move on.

24.1 The three things you can say with total confidence

1. The beachhead is 6.1 million US professionals and you need 1.6% of it to reach 100,000 users. Government data plus arithmetic.
2. The free tier is structurally cheap because everything runs locally. This is an architectural fact, not a forecast.
3. Nobody restores the whole workspace. Verified against OpenAI's documentation, Microsoft's Recall, Raycast's v2.0 release, Granola, and the open-source capture tools.

24.2 The one thing you cannot say yet

"We know it retains." You have a 26-person cohort from a previous build, measured by a method you should check before Monday. That is a signal, not knowledge. Everything else in this book survives being pushed. That one does not — so say it as a signal, and name the test that would turn it into knowledge.